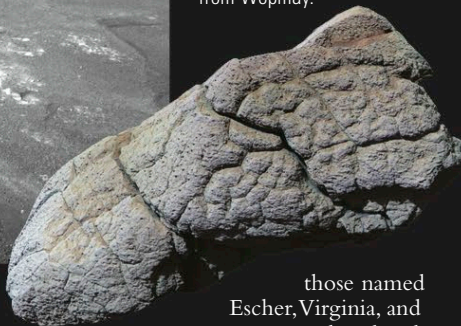




WOPMAY ROCK

The 3-ft (1-m) wide rock Wopmay (below) is one of the loose rocks on the crater floor. The image coloring highlights bluish dots in the rock, which are iron-rich spheres. The rover left wheel tracks in the soil (left) as it drove away from Wopmay.



move off across the adjoining flat plain, Meridiani Planum.

The exposed layers of rock in walls such as Burns Cliff reveal what lies beneath the Martian surface and what geological processes occurred there in the past. The composition of rocks on the crater floor, including

those named Escher, Virginia, and

Wopmay, was analyzed and the finer-grained floor material was scrutinized. All the findings suggest that water has affected the rocks both before and after Endurance was formed.

EXPLORING SPACE

MARTIAN BLUEBERRIES

Dark, round pebbles nicknamed blueberries were found both within and on the terrain outside Endurance Crater. The name is, however, misleading; the pebbles, which appear bluer than their surroundings, are in fact dark gray. The half-inch blueberries are rich in the mineral hematite, which is also found on Earth. Hematite usually forms in lakes and hot springs on Earth, and this supports the idea that this part of Mars has had a watery past. A second type of round pebble that is lighter-colored and rougher-textured has been nicknamed popcorn.



EVIDENCE OF WATER

A mixture of blueberries and popcorn lies on top of a rock called Bylot inside Endurance Crater.

